

ABOUT

Riku Shirokuma

Game Designer · Technical Designer · Tokyo, Japan

Game designer with 9 years across console, mobile and VR, credited on Pokémon Legends Z-A and DYSCHRONIA: Chronos Alternate. Now Lead Game Planner on Puzzle Panic at Limit Break: new mechanics, events and HTML5 prototypes pitched to leadership.

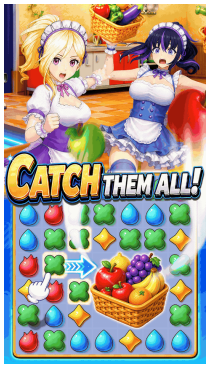
I build what I design: quests, scenes and production tools in Unity, Lua and in-house scripting.

Russian — native Japanese — business English — business

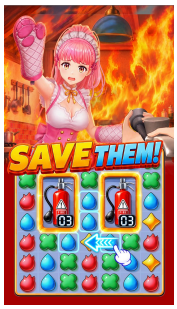
LinkedIn ↗ Pokémon Legends Z-A credits ↗ DYSCHRONIA staff ↗

♦ LIVE-OPS

Puzzle Panic



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ROLE	Lead Game Planner
TEAM	Approximately 70 people
PERIOD	Feb 2025 – Present
ENGINE	Unity; HTML5 for prototypes; Google Spreadsheets

HTML5 · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Claude Code · +2 more

CHALLENGE

A live-ops match-3 shipping episodes and time-limited events on a rolling schedule, with about 70 people on the project. Every new mechanic needed its own specification, a working prototype and a presentation to management, and then had to be integrated into the Unity build without disturbing the existing puzzle balance.

WHAT I DID

- Wrote GDDs for episodes and time-limited events, including the new mechanics behind them.
- Designed new puzzles and obstacles and rebalanced the existing puzzle set.
- Analysed competing titles and researched which mechanics actually work.
- Prototyped events in HTML5 and presented them to management.
- Integrated assets, built scenes, implemented animation, verified triggers, debugged and automated routine work in Unity.
- Coordinated the UI team and supported the producer in working with the UA and sales art teams.
- Interpreted all meetings in Japanese, English and Russian, translated texts EN↔JP and handled Russian localization.

RESULT

Every event reached management as a playable HTML5 prototype rather than a document. The project has been in live operation since February 2025; the Android version is built but not yet released.

♥ STORY

Pokémon LEGENDS Z-A



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ROLE	Planner (Story Team)
TEAM	Story Team: 10 people; 925 people in the credits
PERIOD	2023-10 — 2024-12
ENGINE	Internal 3D engine; Nintendo Switch / Switch 2 SDK

Proprietary tools | Nintendo Switch / Switch 2 | Excel | Word | PowerPoint

CHALLENGE

A large RPG production with more than 30 people on the project and a ten-person Story Team inside the Planning Section. Every side quest needed its own cameras and staging while staying consistent with the direction set for the rest of the game.

WHAT I DID

- Created cameras and cutscenes for every side quest in the game.
- Created cameras and cutscenes for 15–20% of the main story.
- Took part in creating side quests from the initial idea through to implementation.
- Designed the placement of NPCs and Pokémon in the game world.
- Worked through implementation and testing with proprietary tools on Nintendo Switch and Switch 2 hardware.

RESULT

Credited by name in the Story Team of the Planning Section; the end credits list 925 people.

♣ SCENE & DESIGN

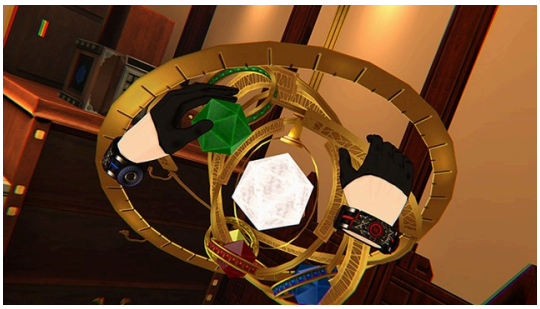
DYSCHRONIA: Chronos Alternate



©Project DYSCHRONIA. Trailer: PlayStation / MyDearest.



©Project DYSCHRONIA.



©Project DYSCHRONIA.

ROLE Game Designer

TEAM Development team: approximately 26 people

PERIOD 2022-04 — 2023-03

ENGINE Unity / VR

In-house script engine | Google Sheets | Confluence | Excel | Word | PowerPoint

CHALLENGE

In VR the player can look anywhere, so scene building and cutscene direction have to carry the story on their own. Stealth sections, puzzles, props and narrative scenes all had to hold together within a 26-person development team.

WHAT I DID

- Developed 3D ADV cutscenes for VR.
- Managed props across the Unity scenes.
- Proposed NPC interactions and achievements.
- Controlled the quality of the cutscene direction.
- Balanced the stealth sections and the puzzles.
- Revised English scripts and debugged builds.
- Proposed improvements to the development tools.

RESULT

Credited as Game Designer on the official staff page of the title.

♠ SYSTEMS

Shadowverse: Champion's Battle



© Cygames, Inc. / trailer XSEEDgames



© Cygames, Inc. / trailer XSEEDgames



© Cygames, Inc. / © アニメ「シャドウバース」製作委員会・テレビ東京

ROLE System Planner

TEAM Approximately 70 people

PERIOD 2020-01 — 2020-05

ENGINE Unity / proprietary Cygames engine (inventory; exact engine unconfirmed)

Lua · Confluence · Nintendo Dev Interface · Visual Studio Code · SourceForge · +3 more

CHALLENGE

Every quest had to stay reachable in whatever order the player took it, so unlock conditions, NPC spawning after completion, day/night branching and rewards formed one dependency graph. Each quest also needed its 3D cutscene staged and checked.

WHAT I DID

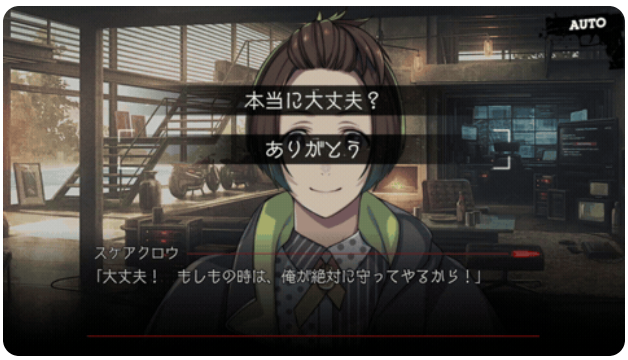
- Designed and implemented all main quests and side quests.
- Built the quest logic: unlock conditions, NPC spawning after completion, day/night branching and reward settings.
- Ensured completability across the entire quest graph.
- Managed NPC placement and spawn conditions against the in-game clock.
- Developed 3D ADV cutscenes and controlled the quality of their direction.
- Debugged quest logic and cutscenes.

RESULT

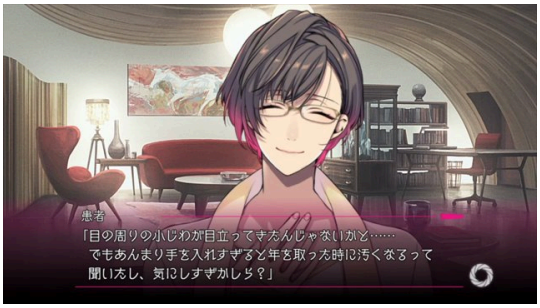
Owned the quest system of a Nintendo Switch title end to end, together with the direction of its cutscenes.

♣ SCENE & DESIGN

BUSTAFELLOWS



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ROLE Game Planner / Scene Direction

TEAM Undisclosed (Indirect Contract)

PERIOD 2019-01 — 2019-02

ENGINE Unity; proprietary tools

In-house script language | EX Excel | WO Word | PO PowerPoint

CHALLENGE

The mystery scenes and ADV cutscenes are what the reading experience rests on, so the staging had to be right. The work covered design, implementation, testing and live operation in a team of five.

WHAT I DID

- Staged scenes for story sequences as the scene director of the mobile version.
- Developed the mystery-solving scenes.
- Developed ADV cutscenes in Unity with the in-house script language.
- Carried scene direction through design, implementation, testing and live operation.

RESULT

Delivered the scene direction of the iOS and Android version from design through live operation.

♦ LIVE-OPS

Yuki Yuna is a Hero: Hanayui no Kirameki



(C)2017 Project 2H (C)KADOKAWA CORPORATION 2017



(C)2017 Project 2H (C)KADOKAWA CORPORATION 2017



(C)2017 Project 2H (C)KADOKAWA CORPORATION 2017

ROLE	Game Planner / Script Planner
TEAM	Live-ops mobile team
PERIOD	2019 — 2023
ENGINE	Unity; proprietary scripting system

In-house script language · Google Sheets · Excel · Word · PowerPoint

CHALLENGE

A live-ops mobile title worked on in three stints between October 2019 and September 2023. Events and their ADV cutscenes had to be scheduled and quality-checked continuously, each stint with a team of three.

WHAT I DID

- Developed ADV cutscenes for story events on a live schedule.
- Controlled the quality of the cutscene direction.
- Managed the schedules of events and their ADV direction in Google Sheets.
- Built scenes in Unity with the in-house script language.
- Supported the title in live operation until the end of service.

RESULT

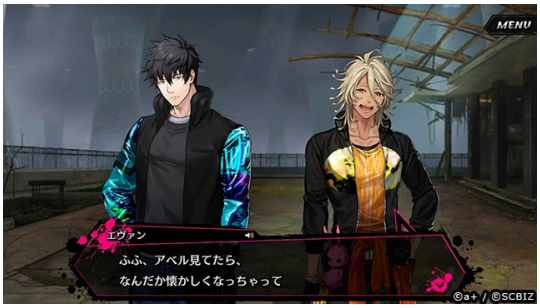
Ran cutscene development, quality control and event scheduling across three live-ops stints between October 2019 and September 2023.

♥ STORY

Shinen Resist



(C)2018 集英社



(C)2018 集英社



(C)2018 集英社

ROLE Script Lead

TEAM 5 (led 4 scripters)

PERIOD 2017-12 — 2019-01

ENGINE Unity; proprietary script engine

In-house script language	SharePoint	Excel	Word	PowerPoint

CHALLENGE

Scene direction on a live mobile RPG where, from March 2018, four scripters had to be directed and new script engine features specified alongside running production. Progress was presented at regular meetings, so the schedule had to hold.

WHAT I DID

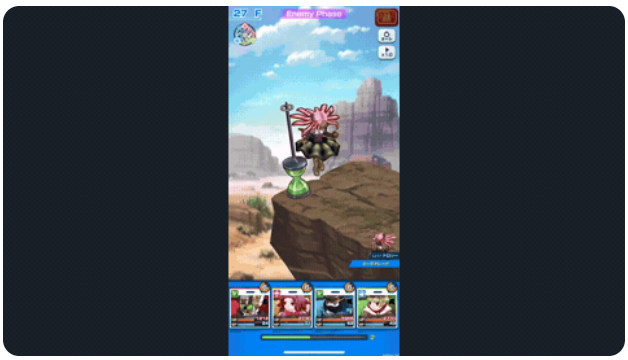
- Directed scenes through design, implementation and live operation.
- Led four scripters as script lead from March 2018.
- Planned new features for the script engine.
- Managed the team members' schedules.
- Controlled the quality of the scene direction.
- Presented progress at regular meetings, preparing materials in PowerPoint and Word.

RESULT

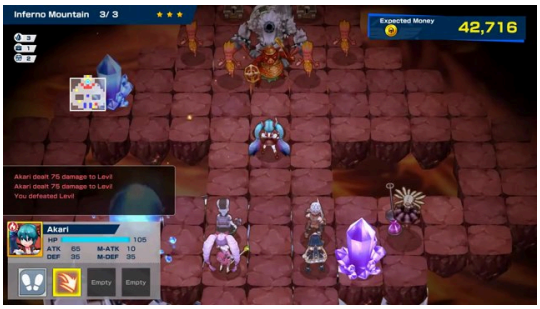
Held scene direction and scripting leadership from December 2017 to January 2019, leading four scripters from March 2018.

♠ SYSTEMS

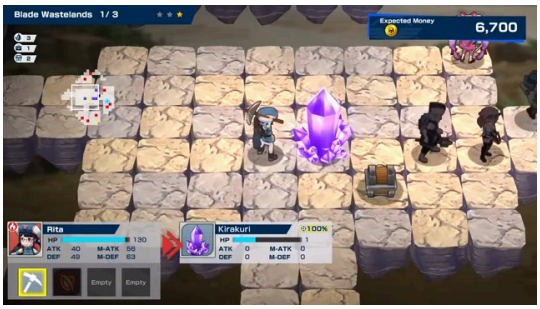
Shacho, Battle no Jikan desu!



©KADOKAWA CORPORATION 2019 ©でらゲー ©PREAPP PARTNERS



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©KADOKAWA CORPORATION 2021 ©PREAPP PARTNERS

ROLE Game Planner

TEAM 4

PERIOD 2017-04 — 2017-12, 2019

ENGINE Unity; Excel; Google Spreadsheets; Confluence

Google Sheets | Confluence | EX Excel | WO Word | PO PowerPoint

CHALLENGE

Two stints on the same mobile RPG: new feature design in 2017 and stage and combat design in 2019. Specifications, master data and balance were owned by the same person in both periods.

WHAT I DID

- Wrote feature specifications, both overview and detailed.
- Created character and event master data.
- Wrote ADV-part scripts and staged them.
- Drafted animation plans for staged sequences.
- Balanced new features, character data and event data.
- Planned stage themes and tuned enemy parameters and placement to match them.
- Balanced skills and equipment.
- Managed the team schedule and debugged builds.

RESULT

Delivered feature specifications, master data and combat balance for the same title across the 2017 and 2019 stints.

✦ PERSONAL EXPLORATION

Personal lab



AI-assisted concept art



AI-assisted concept art

A place to learn by experimenting with concept art, AI-assisted game prototypes, local models and multi-agent orchestration.

GO Godot

UN Unity

OL Ollama

Claude Code

WHAT I AM EXPLORING

- Creating concept art with AI image tools.
- Prototyping a horror game in Godot with AI assistance, set around a D&D gaming table.
- Building small AI-assisted prototypes in Unity.
- Learning to run local models with Ollama on an RTX 3060.
- Orchestrating a multi-agent council with Claude Code.